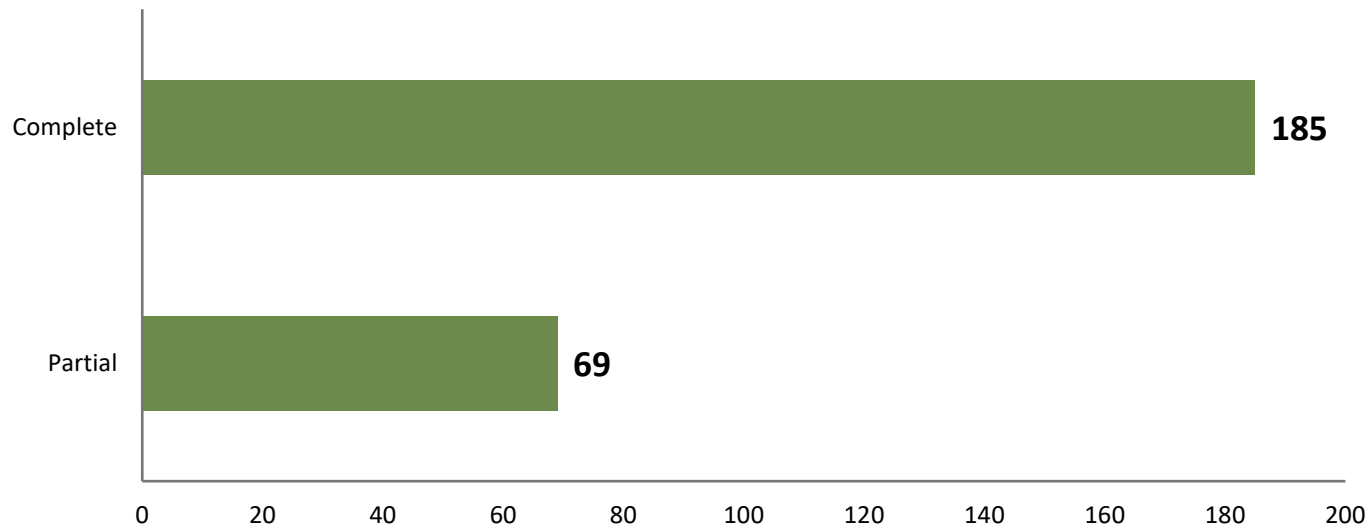




Phase 2 Community Survey

Engagement Summary - June 2025

Participants



Total: 254 participants

KEY THEMES

1. Do you have any comments regarding the DRAFT Community Vision Statement?

“Mower County envisions itself as a vibrant, thriving community that blends its rich agricultural heritage with modern amenities and sustainable practices. Our friendly neighborhoods, connected by well-maintained roads and bike-friendly trails, offer a welcoming environment for all. We celebrate our diverse culture through festivals and community events, fostering a sense of pride and belonging. Together, we build a community that values sustainability and the well-being of all its residents.”

The following page lists key themes to this question.

KEY THEMES

1. Do you have any comments regarding the DRAFT Community Vision Statement?

- Mixed, but generally positive responses toward Vision Statement
- Statement is too long
- Rising cost of living
- Mixed views on “diversity” – more emphasis on safety, pride, and affordability

2. How important is it for Mower County to promote the following in the next 20 years?

	Strongly Important	Somewhat Important	Neutral	Low Importance	Not Important
	%	%	%	%	%
Limit development to areas where there is existing infrastructure or near developed areas.	32.7%	27.6%	19.4%	14.8%	5.6%
Preserve the rural character throughout Mower County.	56.4%	21.3%	10.1%	8.5%	3.7%
Protect agriculture and farming businesses.	72.0%	15.6%	6.5%	4.3%	1.6%
Support industrial development.	40.3%	34.9%	16.1%	6.5%	2.2%
Attract businesses and employers.	58.8%	30.5%	6.4%	2.7%	1.6%
Support existing businesses.	77.4%	18.3%	2.2%	1.1%	1.1%
Expand shopping and retail options.	43.9%	33.7%	8.6%	10.2%	3.7%
Attract more residents.	31.4%	28.6%	16.8%	16.8%	6.5%
Develop a regional food system (e.g. farm to table, local agriculture expansion, farmers markets, etc.).	41.6%	30.3%	17.3%	5.4%	5.4%
Support post-secondary education (e.g., bachelor's degree, associate's degree, trade certification, etc.).	48.6%	31.9%	10.3%	5.9%	3.2%
Diversify the County's tax base.	35.7%	26.9%	32.4%	2.2%	2.7%
Support tourism opportunities.	27.4%	39.2%	14.0%	13.4%	5.9%

KEY THEMES

3. Do you have any comments regarding future development or growth within Mower County? Please provide a brief response below.

- Add and improve recreational facilities (e.g., pickleball courts, bike trails, family activities, recreation center)
- Expand housing options that meet different budgets, including rural and senior housing
- Minimize government spending
- Support job creation and business growth, especially beyond Hormel and in rural areas
- Preserve farmland and rural character

4. Please indicate to what extent you agree or disagree with the following statements about parks, nature areas and trails or walkways in Mower County.

	Strongly agree	Somewhat agree	Neutral	Somewhat disagree	Strongly disagree
	%	%	%	%	%
Parks and nature areas in Mower County meet my and/or my family's routine needs for recreation and nature activities.	32.5%	36.6%	9.9%	16.2%	4.7%
There is a variety of available park facility and play equipment options for children of varying ages and abilities.	36.8%	31.9%	17.8%	10.8%	2.7%
There are a variety of park facility and play equipment options for children with special needs.	14.6%	18.4%	49.7%	12.4%	4.9%
Parks and nature areas are safely accessible by biking and walking.	30.8%	38.9%	15.7%	10.3%	4.3%
Natural resources and areas (groundwater, waterways, woodlands, wildlife, etc.) are well protected.	20.5%	34.6%	20.5%	19.5%	4.9%
Mower County has adequate policies to balance agriculture and environmental protection.	17.3%	23.8%	35.7%	15.1%	8.1%

KEY THEMES

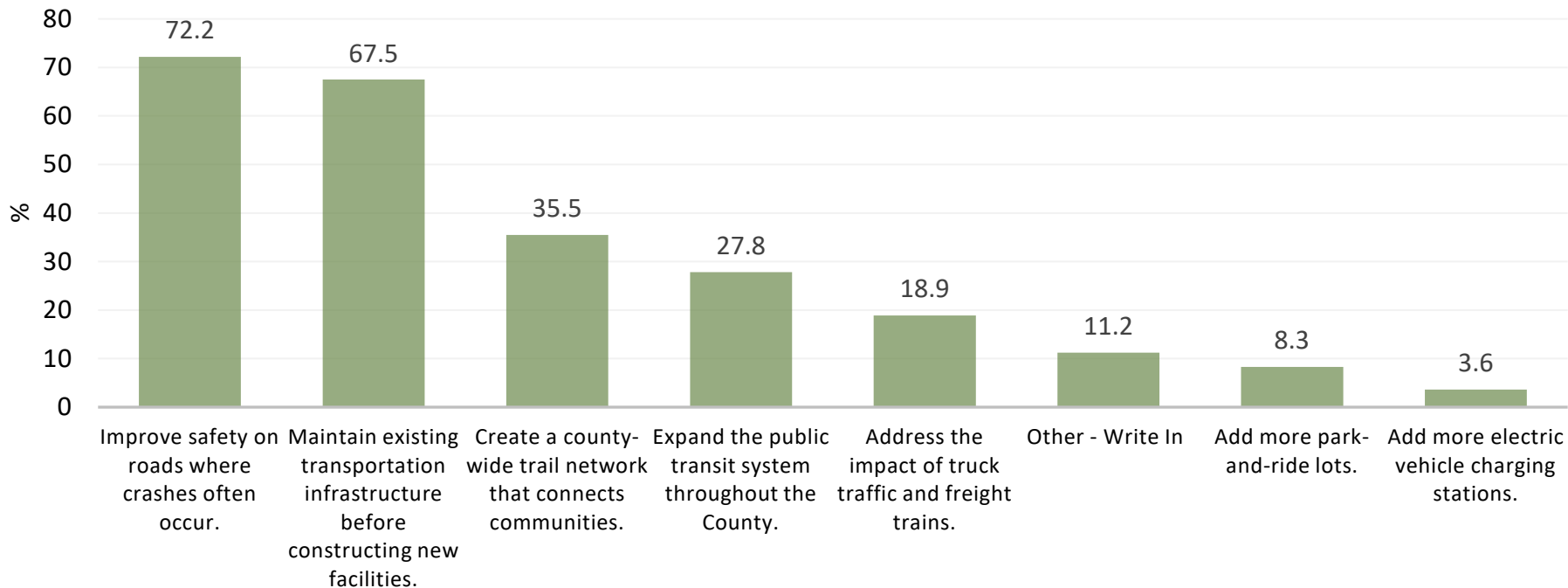
5. Do you have any comments regarding parks and nature areas in Mower County? Please provide a brief response below.

- Mixed opinions on funding for parks and recreation
- Provide recreational amenities (e.g., indoor play areas, pickleball courts, water recreation, movie theaters, mini golf)
- Improve water quality & reduce agricultural runoff
- Enhance trail maintenance and pedestrian/bicycle access
- Preserve natural areas while balancing rural and private land

6. Please rank the most common ways you travel within Mower County. (1 = most common, 4 = least common)

Mode of Travel	Score
1. Driving	742
2. Walking or wheelchair	368
3. Biking	301
4. Transit	151

7. What should Mower County's transportation goals be for the next 20 years? Please select your top three responses.



KEY THEMES

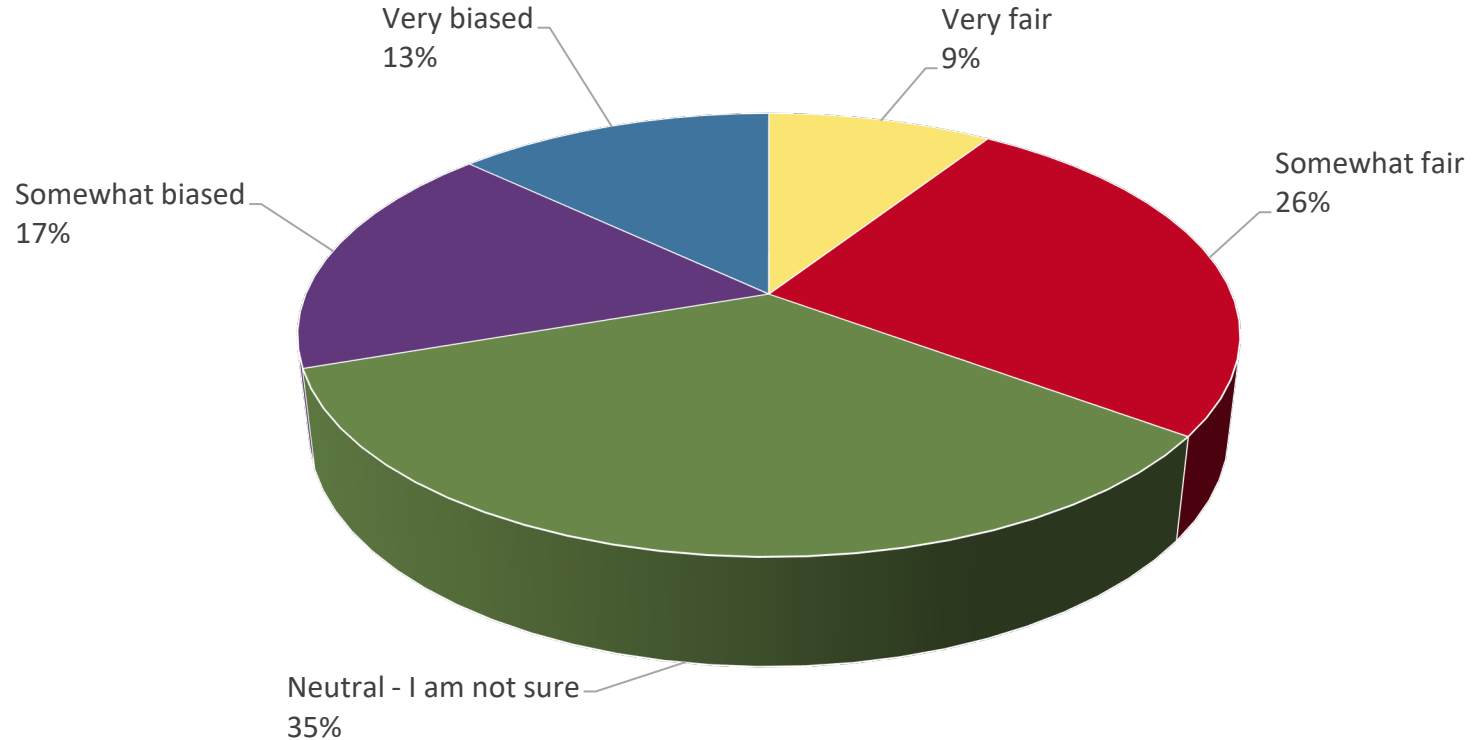
8. Do you have any comments regarding transportation and mobility in Mower County? Please provide a brief response below.

- Need for better road and infrastructure maintenance
- Support for expanding public transportation
- Desire for better pedestrian and bicycle safety
- Mixed opinions on transportation funding and fiscal priorities

9. Please indicate to what extent you agree or disagree with each of the following statements about public utilities and services in Mower County?

	Strongly Agree	Somewhat Agree	Neutral	Somewhat disagree	Strongly disagree
	%	%	%	%	%
Sheriff services are well managed and adequately provided.	29.2%	27.6%	25.9%	9.2%	8.1%
Fire and rescue services are well managed and adequately provided.	38.4%	33.5%	21.6%	4.3%	2.2%
Mower County is responsive, respectful and well managed.	27.0%	31.4%	25.4%	10.3%	5.9%
There is good cooperation between my community and Mower County.	21.9%	29.5%	32.8%	11.5%	4.4%
Broadband and internet services meet my needs.	27.9%	28.4%	7.1%	15.8%	20.8%
There are strong measures to reduce or limit flooding events.	23.8%	29.7%	31.4%	10.3%	4.9%

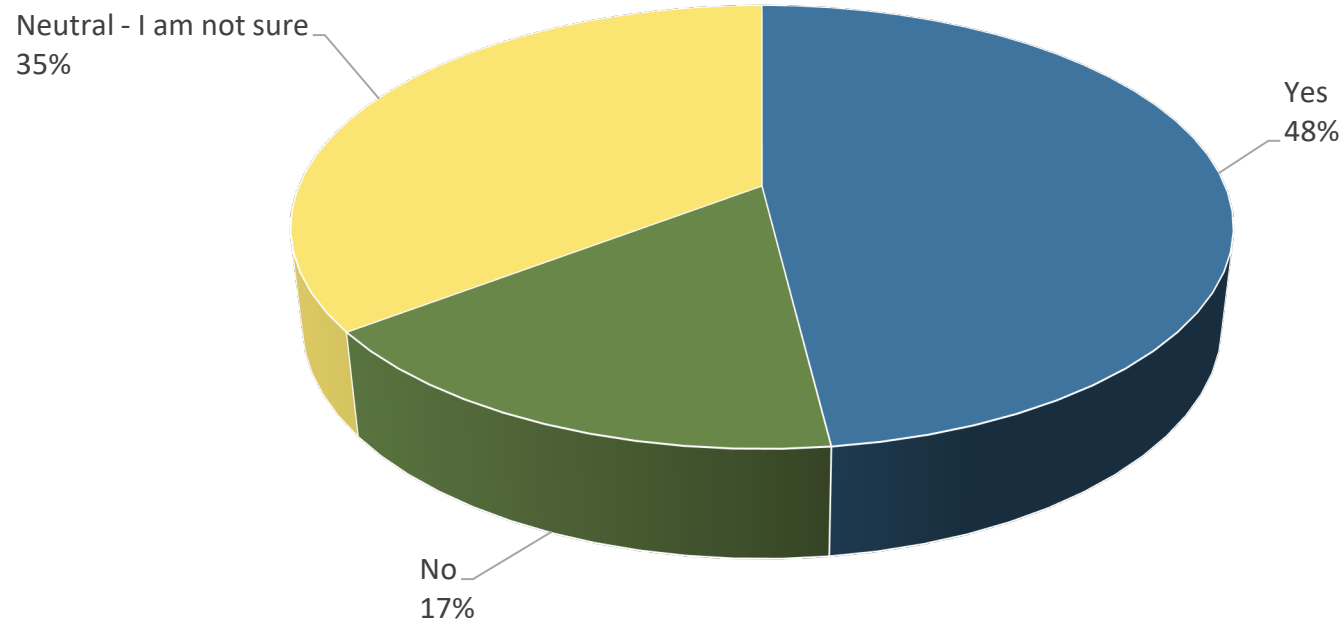
10. How would you rate the fairness of Mower County's decision-making process?



11. Do you have any comments about public facilities, services, or utilities? Please provide a brief response below.

- Mixed opinions on public funding and administrative priorities
- Strong demand for improved law enforcement and emergency services
- Perception that rural areas receive less services compared to City of Austin

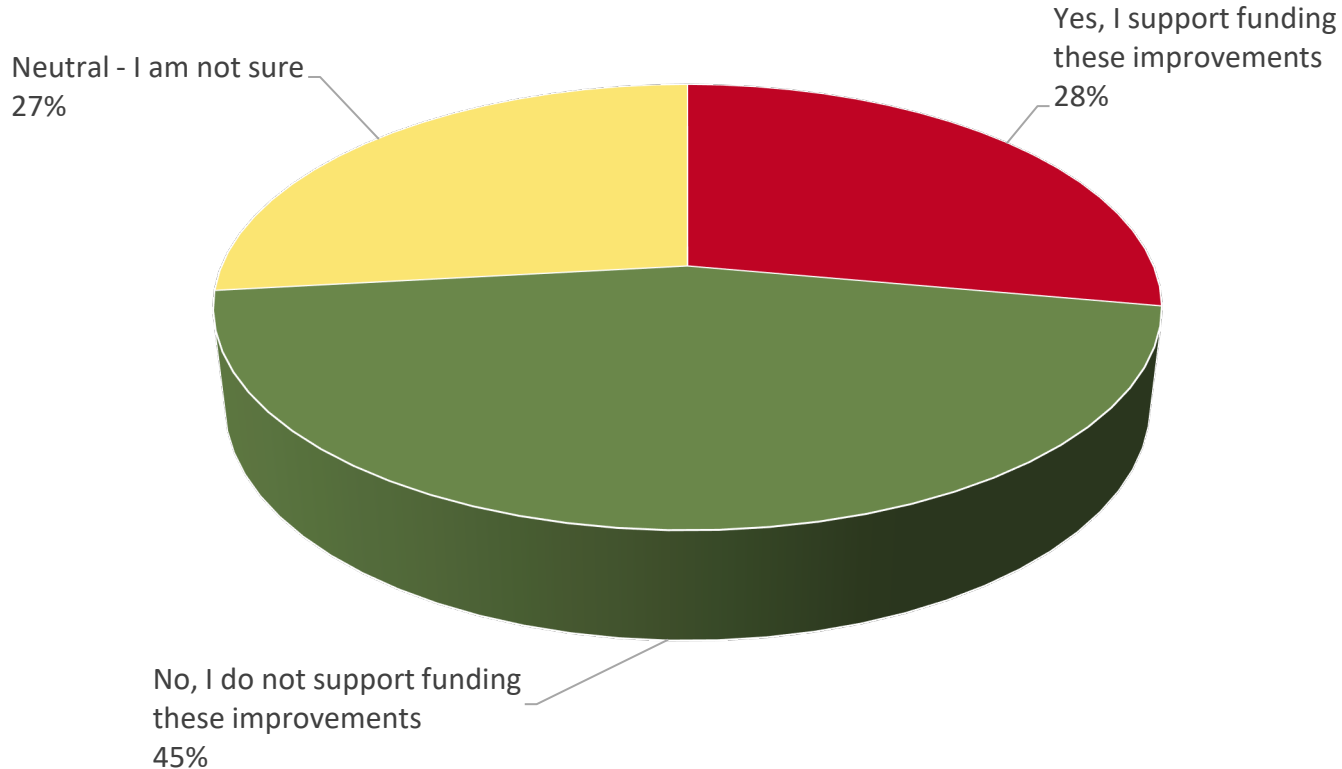
12. Is there a need for more housing in Mower County?



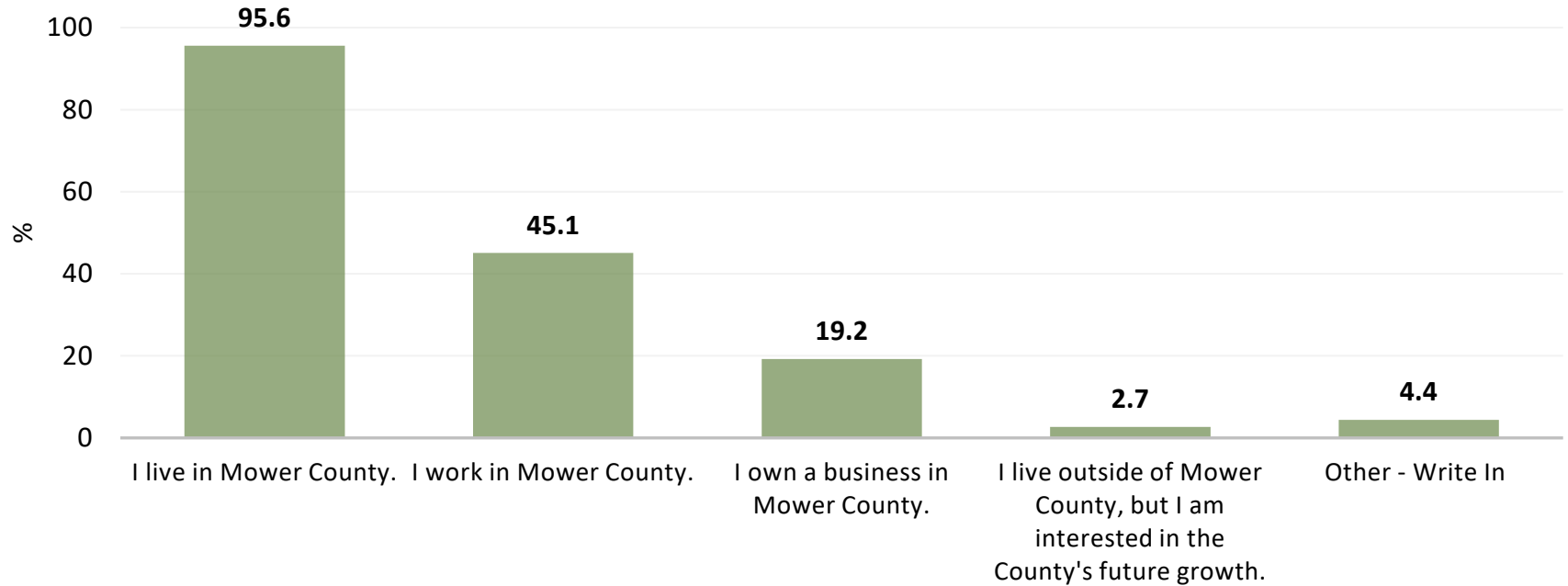
13. Indicate to what extent you agree or disagree with each of the following statements about housing in Mower County.

	Strongly Agree	Somewhat Agree	Neutral	Somewhat Disagree	Strongly Disagree
	%	%	%	%	%
There is an adequate supply of well-maintained housing choices.	4.9%	28.6%	33.5%	22.5%	10.4%
More detached single-family homes are needed.	18.9%	28.3%	42.2%	6.7%	3.9%
More attached single-family homes are needed (town homes, duplexes, etc.).	13.9%	23.9%	40.0%	12.2%	10.0%
More multiple-family homes are needed (condominiums, apartments).	12.3%	26.3%	35.8%	12.8%	12.8%
I'm comfortable with a variety of home types (townhomes, small apartment buildings, single family homes) being mixed within the same neighborhood.	18.4%	25.7%	24.6%	19.0%	12.3%
There is a variety of affordable housing options.	9.0%	22.0%	35.0%	20.3%	13.6%
Neighborhoods should include sidewalks and or trails when they are built.	45.6%	26.1%	13.9%	6.7%	7.8%

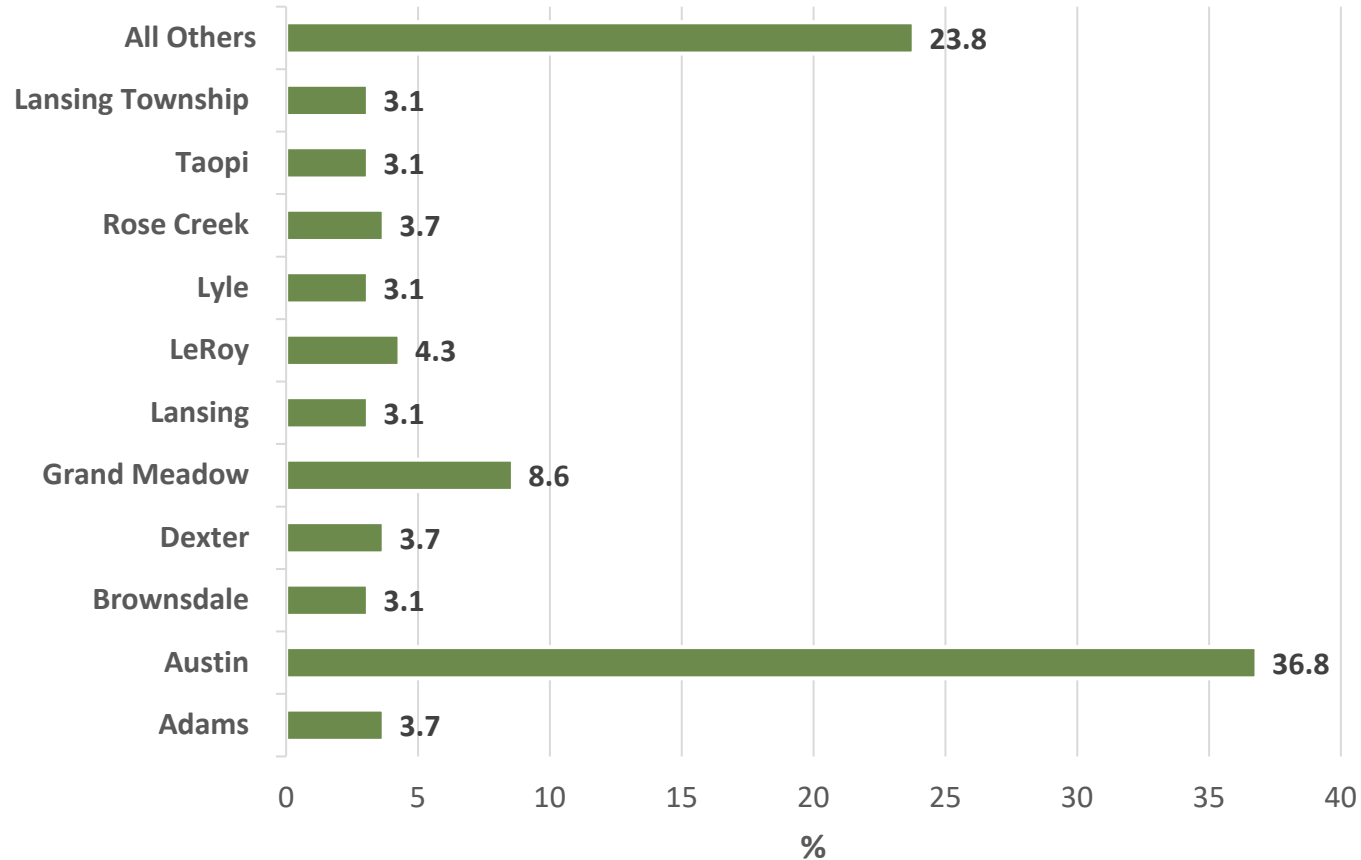
14. Would you support an increase in the county's tax levy to make these improvements in the community?



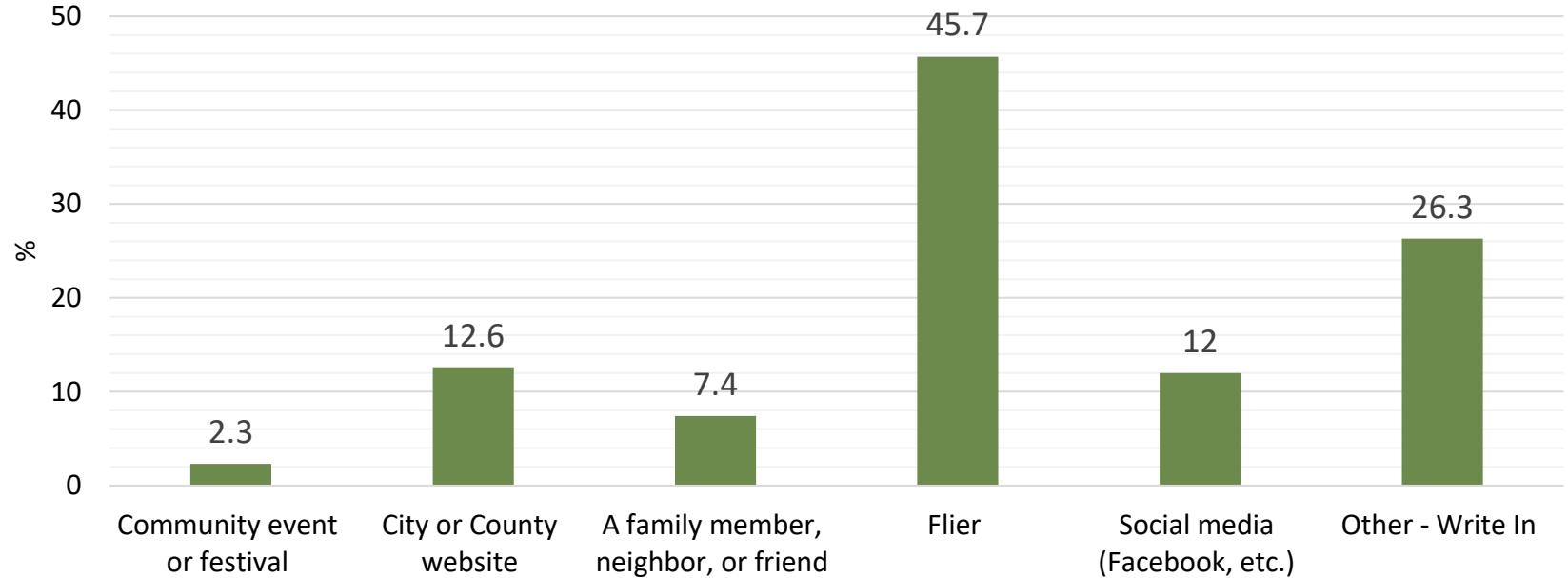
15. What is your relation to Mower County? Please select all that apply.



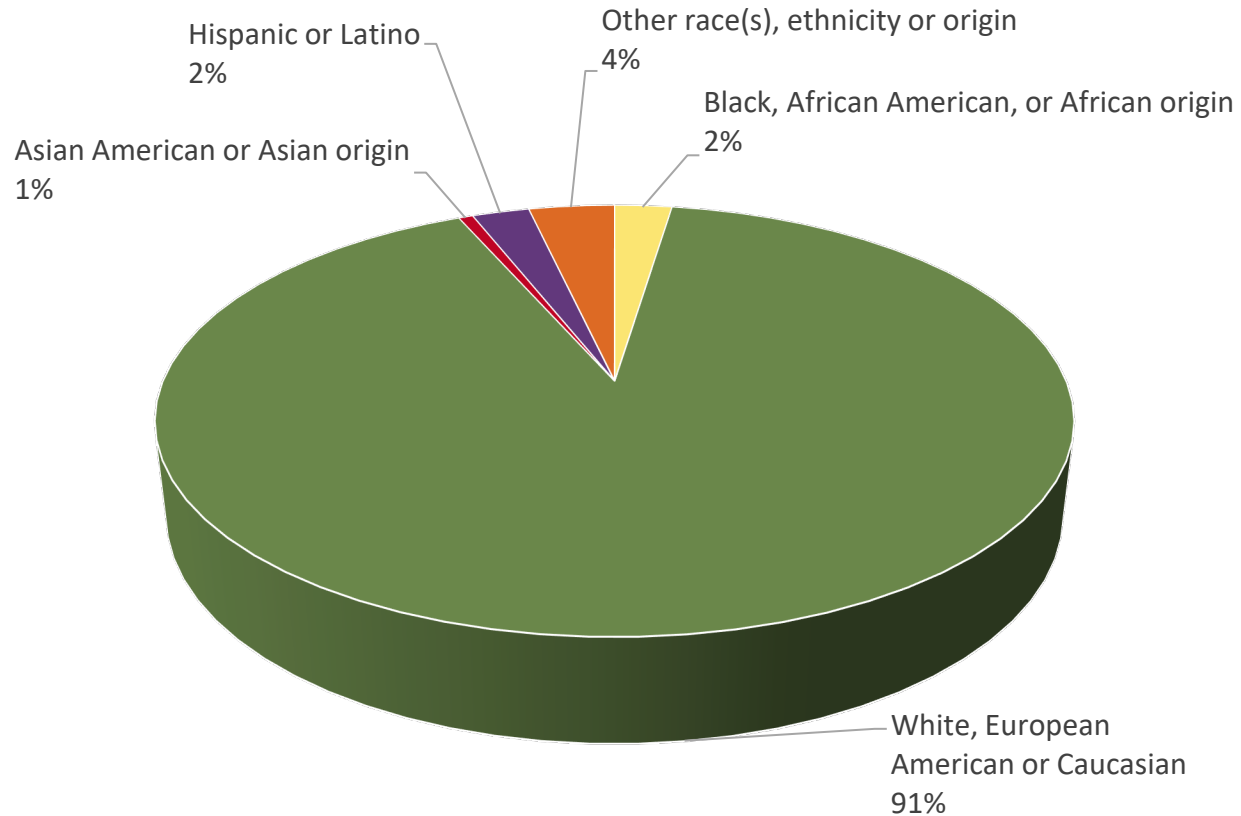
16. What community do you live in?



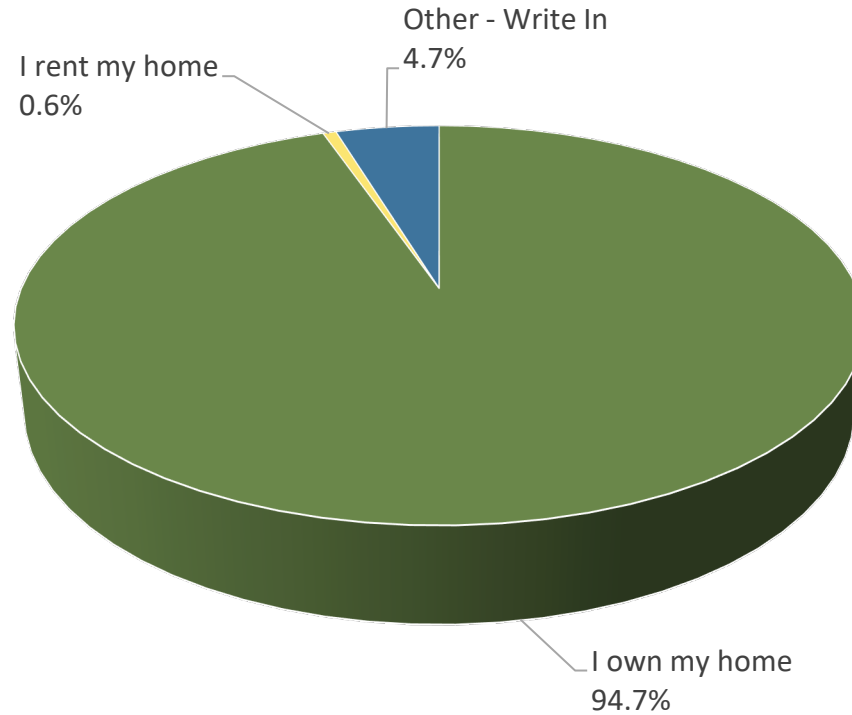
**17. How did you hear about this survey?
Please select all that apply.**



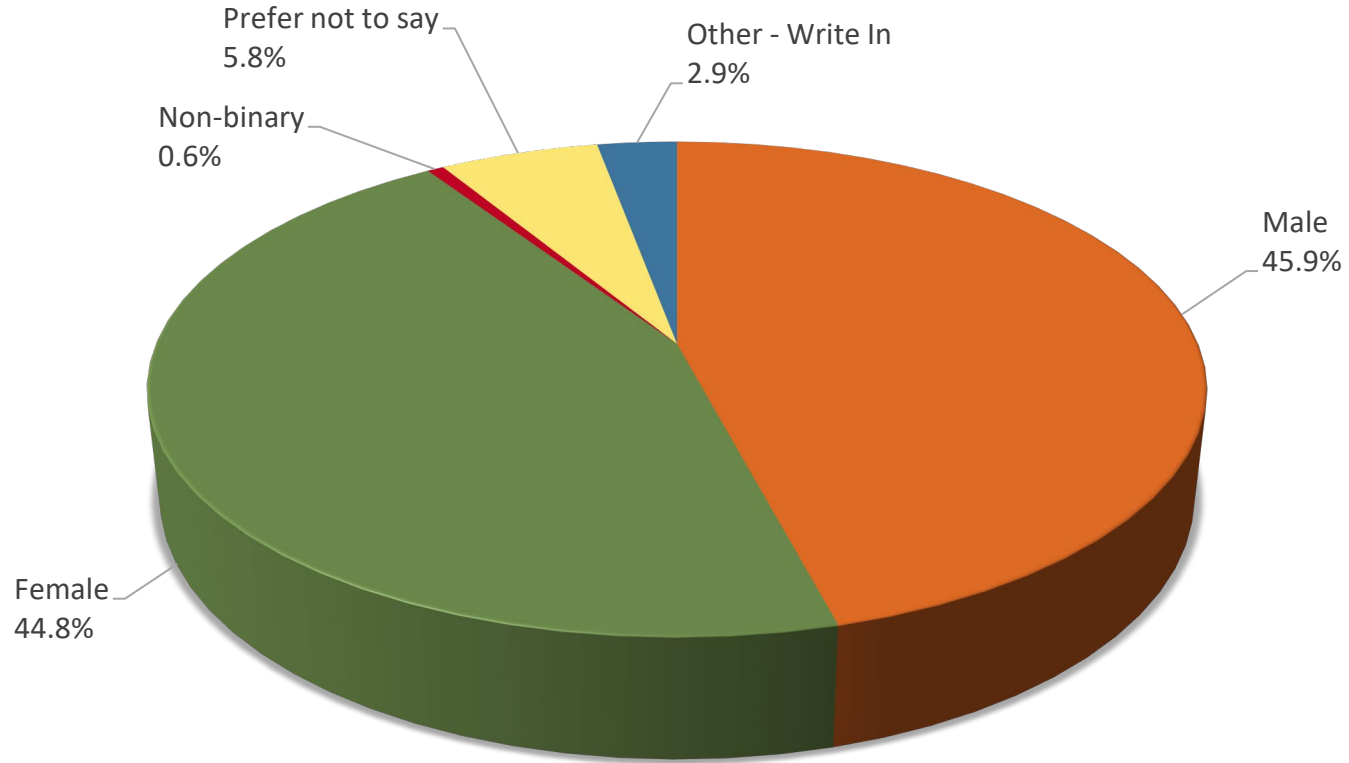
**18. How would you identify your race or ethnicity?
Please select all that apply.**



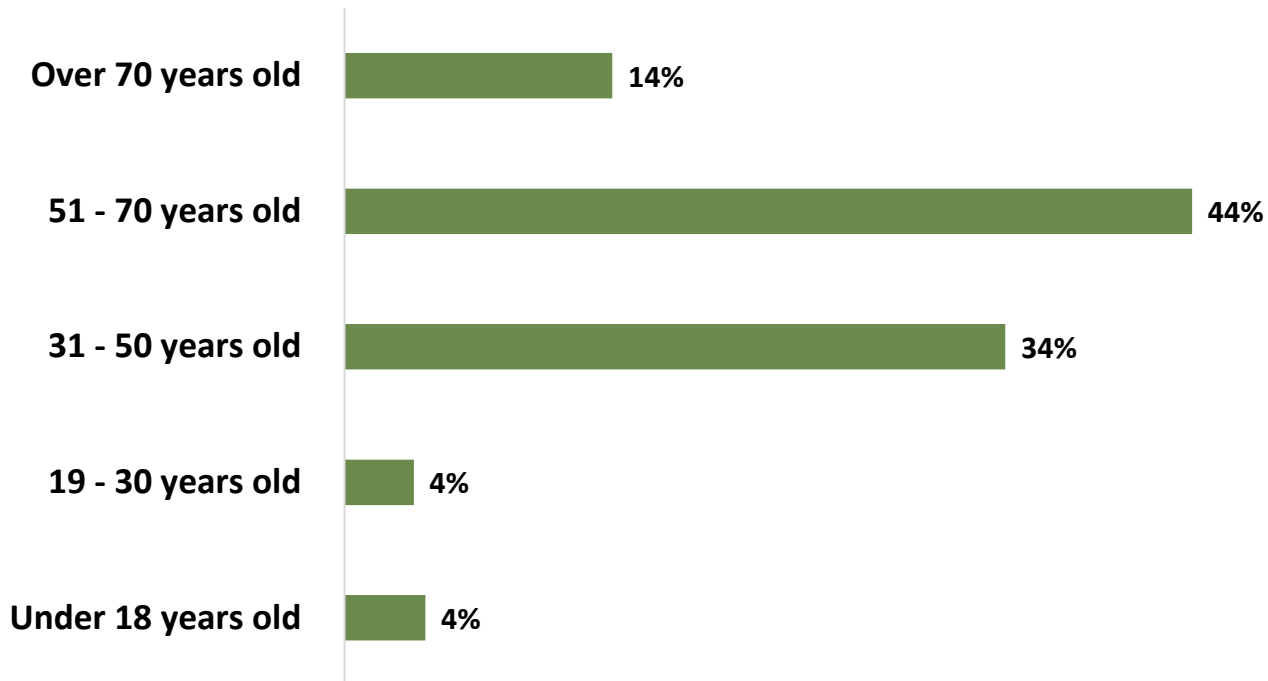
19. Do you own or rent your home?



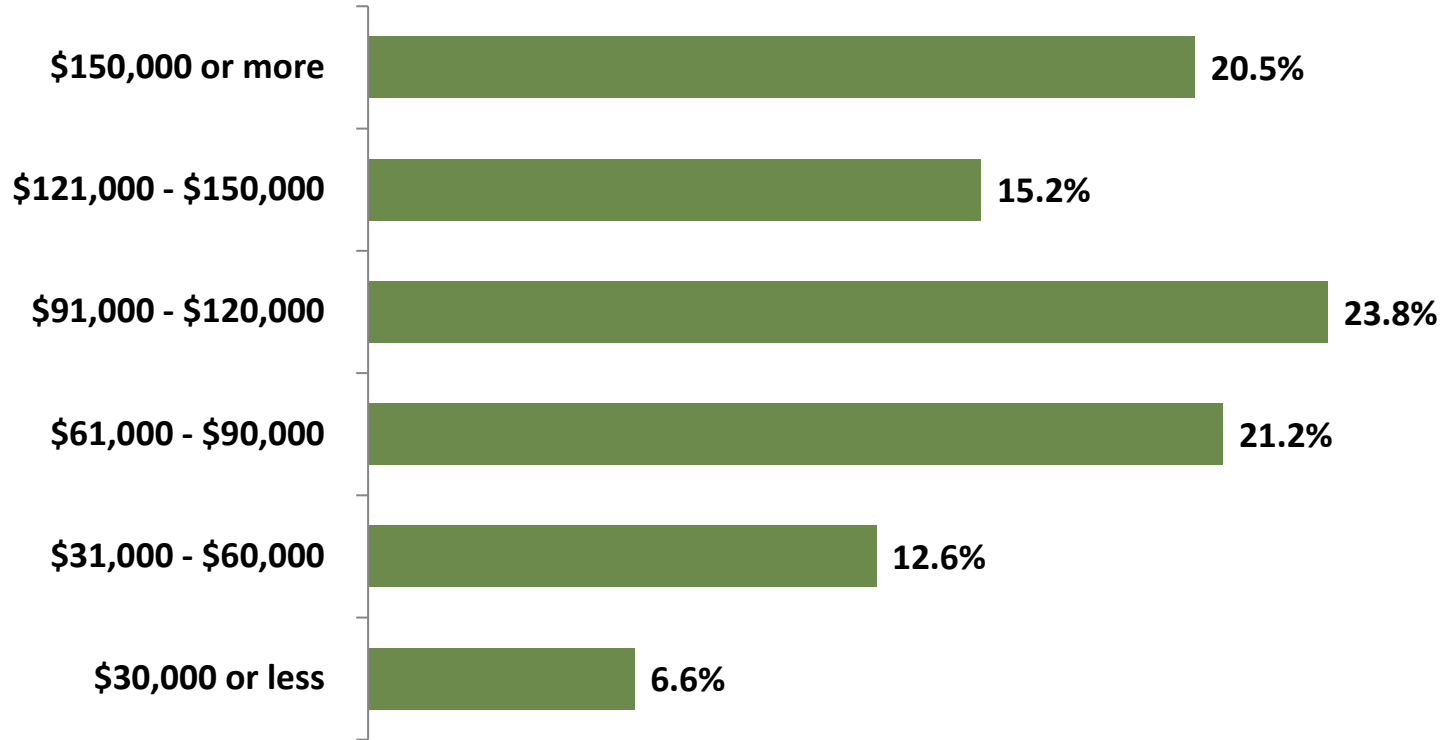
20. How would you identify yourself?



21. What is your age?



22. What is your annual household income?



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Mower County
Comprehensive Plan

City of Austin
Comprehensive Plan

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Project Overview

